

Nora Hammouti

Senior Design Project Manager — Innovation & R&D

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PROFILE

I work where innovation is still uncertain.

On innovation and R&D projects, I lead design expertise alongside the other project stakeholders, drawing on dedicated methodologies to inform decisions and structure project trajectories.

This design-led approach helps surface opportunities before they are even formulated, make complex hypotheses tangible, and align all stakeholders around a shared vision.

My role: turning emerging dynamics into concrete projects, from exploration through to industrialization.

EXPERTISE

Strategic design — R&D Innovation — Emerging technologies — Early-stage concept development — Prototyping — User adoption — Industrialization support — Cross-functional leadership

PORTFOLIO

[→ link to portfolio](#)
(password: access_2026)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aug 2021 – Present

Design Project Manager

EDF Pulse Design,
EDF Lab les Renardières (77) / Tour Légende (92)

Managing a portfolio of around ten innovation projects per year on average — primarily for the hydropower and nuclear business lines, some launched within the year and others carried over from the previous one — at the interface of three groups of stakeholders (my design team, R&D research engineers, and business referents), handling scheduling, technical/usage trade-offs and stakeholder alignment, from opportunity exploration through to proof of concept.

Depending on the briefs and topics at hand, selecting the appropriate expertise (designers, engineers) within my team, and occasionally using design tools (Figma, Fusion 360, KeyShot, etc.) to illustrate directions.

5 demonstrators/prototypes delivered on average per year, roughly a third of which reached an industrialization or operational transfer phase. Design (UX/UI, industrial, foresight) is used as a decision-support tool to reduce uncertainty and speed up decision-making for project sponsors.

Example (nuclear): supported the evolution of an immersive nuclear training tool that lets users explore facilities in 3D and visualize complex physical phenomena. Redesigned the user experience, built an interactive prototype and identified new business use cases for immersive training — including scoping the industrialization path (future web version, associated technical requirements, and field-based acceptance testing with users).

Example (hydropower): supported a field trial of a commercial drone for monitoring the downstream areas of dams (hazardous due to significant water-level variations) — assessing operational use and acceptance, complemented by a perception study among third parties (town hall, gendarmerie, fishing association). Follow-on work included a risk and failure analysis for the Rance tidal power plant, with recommendations and potential solutions. Project co-led with a hydropower operations representative, a drone expert from the General Technical Division, and a nuclear sponsor (with a view to deploying the solution for EPR2 construction site monitoring) — winner of the **Jury Prize in the “Health & Safety” category at the 2026 EDF Pulse Awards**, presented by Bernard Fontana, Chairman and CEO of EDF.

Jan 2020 – Jul 2021

Industrial Designer and Design Project Manager

Y.SPOT,
CEA Grenoble (38)

Led the design mission for 1 year on a spin-off project for a medical wearable device that broke with existing solutions in the sector. Responsible for the industrial design activities and deliverables (alongside a second designer, with no hierarchical relationship) and for the mechatronics workstream (one dedicated engineer). The project was handed over and continued after my departure.

Designed 3 technology demonstrators in micro- and nanotechnology, intended to show industrial partners how these technologies could address concrete applications.

Contributed to forward-looking studies on a range of technology topics, including early-stage thinking on the use cases and feasibility of an upper-limb exoskeleton (Clinatech Platform, CEA) for people with paraplegia.

Sep 2018 – Dec 2019

Product and Industrial Designer

Freelance Consultant,
EDF Lab les Renardières (77) / London (GB)

Design Lab, EDF R&D Renardières: designed innovative solutions stemming from EDF's R&D, for operational business units and private consumers. Contributed to a context-aware assistance system for thermal power plant maintenance technicians (aligning with user needs, defining usage scenarios, and producing visual and audio interfaces); and to an exploratory IoT project reimagining energy-related household objects (light switch, clock, weather station), which was showcased at a design exhibition and featured in specialist press.

Alexandra Gerber Studio: exhibition design work for the "Are You Satisfied" exhibition, for client Verities Magazine.

Sep 2016 – Jul 2017

Industrial Designer (freelance assignments)

ECAL (École Cantonale d'Art de Lausanne),
Lausanne (CH)

Designed bespoke concepts for various companies as part of school-supervised academic projects (Hermès, Retrosuperfuture, Vacheron Constantin, etc.), some in collaboration with the EPFL ECAL Lab — including a store window concept for Vacheron Constantin and an eyewear frame for Retrosuperfuture, made from upcycled acetate waste.

Aug 2015 – Sep 2016

Industrial Designer – Training Facilitator and Curriculum Engineer, Physics Engineering

ENISE (École Nationale d'Ingénieurs de Saint-Étienne),
Saint-Étienne (42)

Drew on a dual skill set — industrial design and teaching — to design curriculum modules in Physics Engineering, organize hands-on workshops, and support undergraduate to graduate-level students on their projects. Prospected and connected with private companies to source real-world topics and challenges for students to work on.

Jun 2014 – May 2015

Intern, then Junior Industrial Designer

Studio Klass,
Milan (IT)

Contributed to a self-supporting modular lighting system for FontanaArte: researched modularity options and proposed mechanical assembly systems for the modules, as well as researching materials for other functional prototypes. Later worked on research and development of industrial product concepts (ideation, modeling, 3D rendering) and produced client presentations.

Mar 2012 – Jul 2012

Production Assistant Intern

Galerie Kreo,
Paris (75)

Tracked the fabrication of works with artisans and manufacturers: coordinated between designers, production workshops and the gallery to ensure piece conformity and deadlines

were met. Notably contributed to production oversight for designer Brynjar Sigurðarson's piece, "The Silent Village Round Table.

EDUCATION

2017	Master of Advanced Studies HES-SO - Design for Luxury and Craftsmanship ECAL – École Cantonale d'Art de Lausanne
2013	DNSEP (French National Diploma in Visual Arts, Design track – equivalent to a Master's degree) ESADSE – École Supérieure d'Art et Design de Saint-Étienne
2008	Bachelor's in Physics (2 years completed) UCL - Université Claude Bernard, Lyon 1
2005	Scientific Baccalaureate (French high-school diploma), Physics-Chemistry track Lycée Claude Fauriel, Saint-Étienne

LANGUAGES

French — Native | English — Professional working proficiency